

Saturday, 5 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Partly cloudy 22° 14°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 20° 13°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 19° 14°	GLASGOW Light rain 16° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A government minister is urging people to stock up on food and supplies to prepare for potentially extreme winter weather.

Dame Angela Eagle warned that a significant weather event could bring severe storms across the UK. She advised households to be ready for potential disruptions. This follows recent discussions about national resilience.

WEATHER · UK
- 2

The controversial Jackdaw gas field, off the coast of Aberdeen, is reportedly set to receive government approval within weeks.

Sources suggest the go-ahead is imminent for the project, despite ongoing environmental concerns. This decision comes as the UK grapples with energy security and climate commitments. The field is expected to boost domestic gas supply.

ENERGY · UK
- 3

Five people have been jailed after a kidnap victim bravely escaped by jumping from a window.

Police say the man was held captive and repeatedly assaulted, with the ordeal filmed by his captors. His dramatic escape led to the arrests and subsequent convictions. This case highlights the dangers of organised crime.

CRIME · UK
- 4

A warning has been issued after jobseekers, particularly from Gen Z, were targeted in sophisticated interview scams.

Fraudsters are reportedly using fake, booby-trapped recruitment apps to trick unsuspecting applicants. Authorities are urging caution and vigilance when applying for jobs online. This highlights the growing threat of cybercrime.

SCAM · UK
- 5

The British Army has reportedly been told to halt non-essential training exercises to save money.

Units not preparing for deployment are being asked to cut back due to significant cost pressures. This move raises questions about military readiness and budget constraints. It affects training across the UK.

DEFENCE · UK

What's coming up

- 1** **Wolverhampton-born comedian and actress Meera Syal says she 'not only survived, but thrived' in her career, in her new memoir.**

The much-loved star is sharing her experiences and journey in the entertainment industry. Her book promises an insightful look into her life and work. It's sure to be a fascinating read for fans.

ON AIR – What's a memoir you've read recently that really stuck with you?

BOOK · UPCOMING
- 2** **Former Great British Bake Off star Prue Leith says ageing is something to celebrate, declaring 'you come into your own growing old'.**

The much-loved chef and presenter shared her positive outlook on getting older. She believes there's much to enjoy and learn with age. A refreshing perspective from a national treasure.

ON AIR – Do you agree with Prue? Is getting older something to celebrate?

TV · ONGOING
- 3** **Stars of the hit Netflix drama 'The Gentlemen' have reacted to reports about Meghan Markle's potential involvement in the show's future.**

The world premiere for the second series took place in London this week. Cast members shared their thoughts on the rumours, with one saying they'd 'be the last to know'. Excitement is building for the new episodes.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of 'The Gentlemen'? What are you hoping for in the new series?

TV · UPCOMING
- 4** **Oasis fans have reportedly cracked the code for potential upcoming gigs at Celtic Park, thanks to a chip shop video.**

Internet sleuths spotted numbers in posters that appear to be map co-ordinates for the Glasgow stadium. This has sparked huge excitement among fans for a possible reunion or new shows. Watch this space!

ON AIR – Are you an Oasis fan? Would you travel to see them if they reunited?

MUSIC · UPCOMING
- 5** **A stunning new anamorphic mural of rock legend Freddie Mercury has been unveiled at Wembley Park.**

The artwork only resolves into a clear image when viewed from a specific spot, creating a unique visual experience. It's a fantastic tribute to the iconic Queen frontman. Definitely worth a visit for music fans!

ON AIR – What's your favourite Freddie Mercury or Queen song?

ART · ONGOING

On the schedule

1 **Tennis star Aryna Sabalenka briefly halted her US Open match after complaining about the strong smell of cannabis.**

The world number one paused play during her fourth-round match against Kamilla Rakhimova. Despite the unusual distraction, Sabalenka went on to secure her place in the next round. It certainly caused a stir!

ON AIR – Have you ever had a sporting event interrupted by something unexpected?

TENNIS · THIS WEEK

2 **Lewis Hamilton believes Ferrari's new engine is an improvement, but says Mercedes are still lagging behind on the straights.**

The British F1 star was speaking at the Italian Grand Prix, where teams are pushing for every advantage. It highlights the ongoing battle for supremacy in Formula 1. The season is heating up!

ON AIR – Are you following the F1 season? Who do you think will come out on top?

F1 · THIS WEEK

3 **Great Britain and Ireland are hoping strong winds in the west of Ireland could help them secure a rare Walker Cup win.**

The conditions are expected to play a significant role in the prestigious amateur golf tournament. The home team will be looking to use the challenging weather to their advantage. It promises to be a gripping contest.

ON AIR – Do you think home advantage, especially with weather, makes a big difference in sport?

GOLF · THIS WEEK

4 **Women's boxing greats have paid tribute to Katie Taylor as she prepares to retire after her fight this Saturday.**

Stars like Claressa Shields and Amanda Serrano have honoured the Irish boxing legend. Taylor's final bout against Flora Pili is set to be an emotional occasion. She leaves a remarkable legacy in the sport.

ON AIR – Who is your favourite female athlete who has inspired you?

BOXING · THIS WEEK

5 **There are some surprise pacesetters and resurgent runs to watch out for in the EFL this weekend.**

The Championship, League One, and League Two action promises plenty of talking points. Teams are battling it out early in the season, with unexpected results already shaking things up. It's all to play for!

ON AIR – Are you following any of the EFL teams this season? Who are you tipping for promotion?

FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that taking a 'micro-break' to look at something green can boost your concentration and mood.**
Researchers found that even a 40-second glimpse of a natural scene from a window or on a screen can significantly improve focus and reduce stress during tasks.
- 2 The simple pleasure of 'writing a letter' is experiencing a quiet resurgence, with many finding it a calming alternative to digital communication.**
Pen pal clubs and letter-writing workshops are growing in popularity, as people rediscover the joy of a tangible message through the post.
- 3 Experts are highlighting the benefits of 'baking bread from scratch' not just for the taste, but for mental well-being too.**
The rhythmic kneading and the comforting aroma are said to be therapeutic, offering a lovely sense of accomplishment and a delicious reward.
- 4 A delightful trend sees people creating miniature 'terrariums' at home, bringing a tiny piece of nature indoors.**
These self-contained ecosystems are not only beautiful to look at but are also surprisingly easy to maintain, perfect for adding a touch of green to any room.
- 5 The art of 'patchwork and quilting' is enjoying a vibrant comeback, with crafters creating beautiful, unique textiles.**
It's a wonderful way to repurpose fabric scraps and create something truly personal, often with a cosy and nostalgic feel.
- 6 More people are discovering the joy of 'urban foraging' for ingredients like wild garlic or berries in city parks and green spaces.**
Always with careful identification, this trend connects city dwellers with nature and offers a fresh, free bounty for their kitchens.
- 7 A growing number of individuals are embracing 'mindful photography', using their cameras to truly observe the world around them.**
This approach encourages slowing down and appreciating details, turning a simple walk into an artistic and calming experience.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of shampoo will be good, without actually opening the bottle and smelling it first?

ANSWER: SQUEEZING THE BOTTLE GENTLY TO FEEL HOW THICK THE LIQUID IS.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm bath, especially if it's a new bath bomb. What is it?

ANSWER: WATCHING IT FIZZ AND DISSOLVE COMPLETELY BEFORE GETTING IN.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday sound' can just make you feel instantly happy or bring a smile to your face, even if it's something really ordinary?

What's that one sound that just never fails to cheer you up or make you feel warm and fuzzy inside? Is it the kettle boiling, a cat purring, or something else entirely?

- We all have that 'one household chore' that we secretly, or not so secretly, find quite satisfying to do, don't we, even if it's a bit mundane?

What's your go-to chore that you actually enjoy doing, perhaps because of the immediate results or the calm it brings? Is it Hoovering, washing up, or something else entirely?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** The 'Potoo bird' is a master of camouflage, able to perfectly blend into tree stumps by imitating a broken branch, even striking a pose for hours.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Cats can make over 100 different sounds, whereas dogs can only make about 10. The variety comes from their need to communicate complex emotions.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's largest officially recorded snowflake was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, falling in Montana, USA, in 1887.
- The small pocket on a pair of jeans was originally designed for pocket watches.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- Strawberries are the only fruit that wear their seeds on the outside.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- A 'group of rhinos' is called a crash.

On this day

Day 248 of the year, 117 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Bertin; Christian feast day: Charbel (martyr); Christian feast day: Genebald; Christian feast day: Gregorio Aglipay (Episcopal Church). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1952 — David Glen Eisley, American rock singer-songwriter and actor
- 1988 — Emmy Raver-Lampman, American actress and singer
- 1968 — Brad Wilk, American singer-songwriter and drummer
- 1939 — William Devane, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1991 — Skandar Keynes, English actor and political adviser
- 1951 — Michael Keaton, American actor and producer
- 1969 — Mark Ramprakash, English cricketer and coach
- 1946 — Loudon Wainwright III, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1981 — The first women arrive at what becomes Greenham Common Women's Peace Camp in the UK.
- 2006 — The Waziristan Accord is signed between the Government of Pakistan and local Taliban militants in North Waziristan, obliging the Taliban to expel foreign jihadists and the government to compensate the tribes for loss of life and property and launch reconstruction projects.
- 1984 — Western Australia becomes the last Australian state to abolish capital punishment.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1975 — Sacramento, California: Lynette Fromme attempts to assassinate U.S. President Gerald Ford.
- 1990 — Sri Lankan Civil War: Sri Lankan Army soldiers slaughter 158 civilians.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1981 — The first women arrive at what becomes Greenham Common Women's Peace Camp in the UK.
- 1945 — Cold War: Igor Gouzenko, a Soviet Union embassy clerk, defects to Canada, exposing Soviet espionage in North America, signalling the beginning of the Cold War.

- 1984 — Western Australia becomes the last Australian state to abolish capital punishment.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 249 of the year, 116 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Begga; Christian feast days: Chagnoald; Christian feast days: Faustus, Abibus and Dionysius of Alexandria; Christian feast days: Gondulphus of Metz. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1944 — Swoosie Kurtz, American actress
- 1939 — David Allan Coe, American outlaw country music singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2026)
- 1943 — Roger Waters, English singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1972 — Anika Noni Rose, American actress and singer
- 1993 — Famous Dex, American rapper
- 2002 — Asher Angel, American actor
- 1980 — Jillian Hall, American wrestler and singer
- 1969 — CeCe Peniston, American singer-songwriter, actress, and former beauty pageant winner

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1986 — In Istanbul, two terrorists from Abu Nidal's organization kill 22 and wound six congregants inside the Neve Shalom Synagogue during Shabbat services.
- 2012 — Sixty-one people die after a fishing boat capsizes off the İzmir Province coast of Turkey, near the Greek Aegean islands.
- 2013 — Forty-one elephants are poisoned with cyanide in salt pans, by poachers in Hwange National Park.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1988 — End of the last stage of the Anfal campaign of Ba'athist Iraq against its Kurdish population, which resulted in major destructions and major civilian losses.
- 1976 — Cold War: Soviet Air Defence Forces pilot Viktor Belenko lands a Mikoyan-Gurevich MiG-25 jet fighter at Hakodate in Japan and requests political asylum in the United States; his request is granted.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar